

Salesforce Expense Tracker – Full Documentation

1. Problem Understanding & Analysis

Problem:

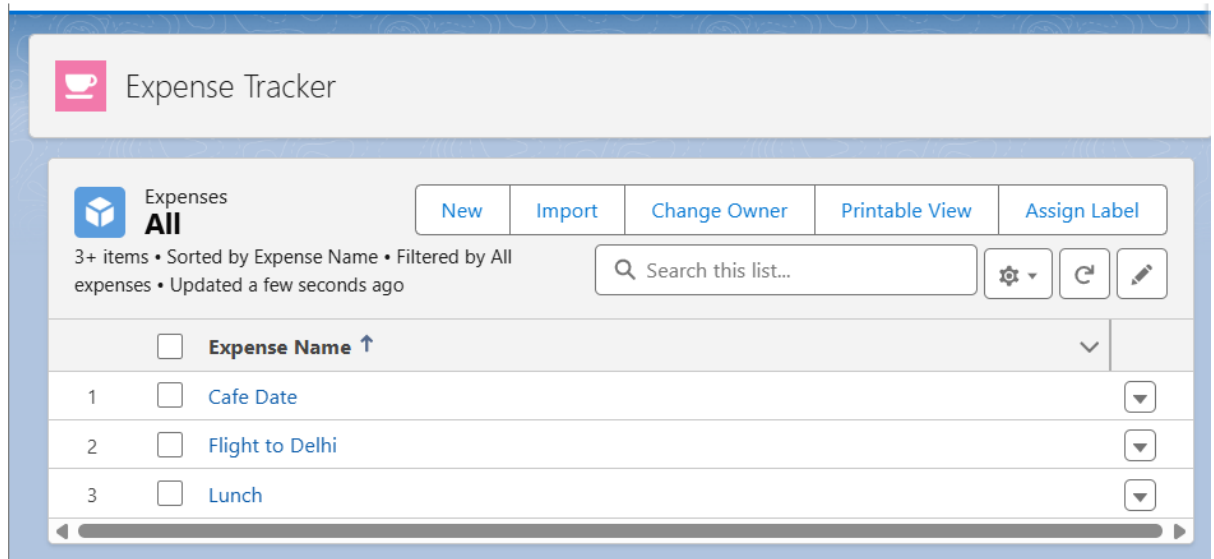
Employees need a way to submit expenses, and the company wants to track them efficiently. High-value expenses should be reviewed automatically by a manager or CEO.

Requirements:

- Track Expense Name, Amount, Date, Category, Status.
 - Automatically flag high expenses (>500) for review.
 - Simple UI for creating and viewing expenses.
 - Basic reporting to see total expenses by category.
 - Track approval/rejection history (user and date).
 - Maintain secure visibility using roles and sharing settings.
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2. Org Setup & Configuration

1. Use a **Salesforce Developer Org**.



2. All configurations done in the **default org**.
 3. Roles and sharing settings configured for CEO and Finance Manager.
-

3. Data Modeling & Relationships

Step 1: Create Custom Object – Expense

1. Setup → Object Manager → Create → Custom Object
 2. Details:
 - **Label:** Expense
 - **Plural Label:** Expenses
 - **Record Name:** Expense Name (Text)
 - **Check:** Allow Reports, Allow Activities
 3. Save
-

Step 2: Add Custom Fields

Field Label	Data Type	Notes
Amount	Currency(16,2)	Expense amount
Date	Date	Expense date
Category	Picklist	Travel, Food, Office, Other
Status	Picklist	Submitted, Need Approval, Approved, Rejected
Approved By	Lookup(User)	CEO who approves/rejects
Approval Date	Date/Time	Approval/rejection timestamp
Rejection Reason	Text Area	Reason for rejection

Save each field.

SETUP > OBJECT MANAGER

Expense

Details
Fields & Relationships
Page Layouts
Lightning Record Pages
Buttons, Links, and Actions
Compact Layouts
Field Sets
Object Limits
Record Types
Related Lookup Filters
Search Layouts
List View Button Layout

New
Deleted Fields
Field Dependencies

FIELD LABEL	FIELD NAME	DATA TYPE	CONTROLLING
Amount	Amount__c	Currency(16, 2)	
Category	Category__c	Picklist	
Created By	CreatedById	Lookup(User)	
Date	Date__c	Date	
Expense Name	Name	Text(80)	
Last Modified By	LastModifiedById	Lookup(User)	
Owner	OwnerId	Lookup(User,Group)	
Status	Status__c	Picklist	

Step 3: Create a Tab for Expense

1. Setup → Tabs → New → Custom Object Tab
2. Object: Expense
3. Choose a tab style
4. Save → Expenses tab appears in App Launcher

4. Roles and Users

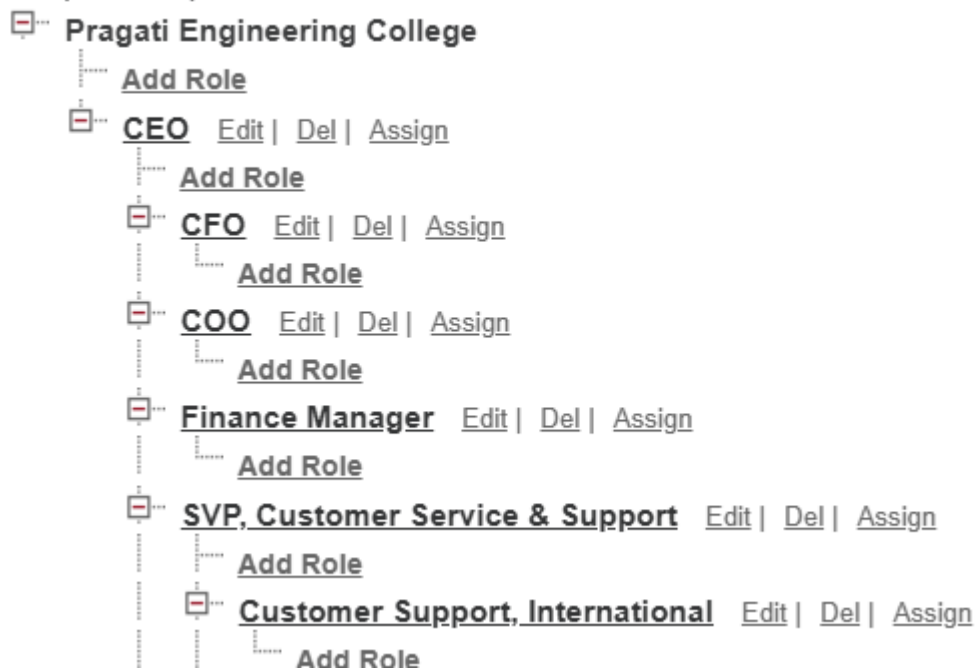
Roles

CEO

└ Finance Manager

- **CEO:** Oversees and approves/rejects expenses
- **Finance Manager:** Creates expense records

[Collapse All](#) [Expand All](#)



Users

User	Role	Profile	Description
CEO User	CEO	System Admin	Approves/rejects expenses
Finance Manager	Finance Manager	Standard User	Creates expenses (access via Permission Set)

5. Sharing Settings

- **Setup** → **Sharing Settings** → **Expense__c**
- **Default Internal Access:** Private
- **Role Hierarchy:** Enabled

Result:

- Finance Manager sees only own records.
 - CEO sees all records.
-

6. Validation Rules

Lock Approved or Rejected Expenses

AND(

OR(

```

    ISPICKVAL(Status__c, 'Approved'),
    ISPICKVAL(Status__c, 'Rejected')
),
OR(
    ISCHANGED(Amount__c),
    ISCHANGED(Category__c),
    ISCHANGED(Date__c)
)
)
)

```

Error Message: “Approved or Rejected expenses cannot be edited.”

Expense Validation Rule

[Help for this Page](#) 

[Back to Expense](#)

Validation Rule Detail

Edit

Clone

Rule Name	val1	Active	☒
Error Condition Formula	AND(OR(ISPICKVAL(Status__c, 'Approved'), ISPICKVAL(Status__c, 'Rejected')), OR(ISCHANGED(Amount__c), ISCHANGED(Category__c), ISCHANGED(Date__c))))		
Error Message	Approved or Rejected expenses cannot be edited.	Error Location	Top of Page

7. Process Automation – Record-Triggered Flows

A. Auto-Flag High Expenses (>500)

Flow Name: AutoFlag_High_Expenses

1. **Trigger:** Record-Triggered Flow on Expense__c, when created
2. **Condition:** Amount__c > 500

3. **Action:** Update the record → Status__c = Need Approval
4. **Run Flow:** After the record is saved
5. **Save & Activate**

The screenshot displays the Salesforce Flow Builder interface for a flow named 'Expense Tracker - V1'. The flow is a 'Record-Triggered Flow' that starts with a 'Start' node, followed by a 'Run Immediately' node, and then an 'Update Status to Need...' action (Update Records). The flow is currently in the 'Active' state, as indicated by the green 'Active' button in the top right. The 'Update Records' action is configured with the following settings:

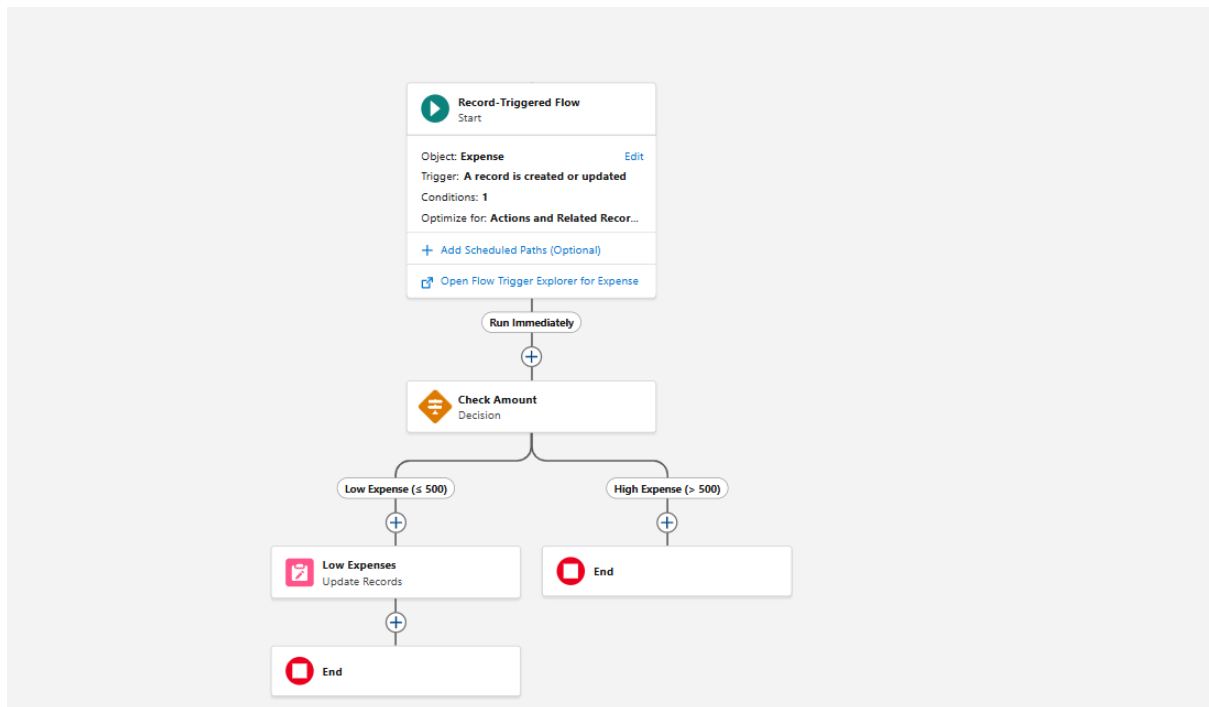
- Object:** Expense
- Trigger:** A record is created
- Conditions:** 1
- Optimize for:** Actions and Related Records
- How to Find Records to Update and Set Their Values:**
 - ☒ Use the expense record that triggered the flow
 - ☐ Update records related to the expense record that triggered the flow
 - ☐ Use the IDs and all field values from a record or record collection
 - ☐ Specify conditions to identify records, and set fields individually
- Set Filter Conditions:**
 - Condition Requirements to Update Record: None—Always Update Record
- Set Field Values for the Expense Record:**
 - Field: Status
 - Value: Need Approval

B. Auto-Update Approval Fields on CEO Action

Flow Name: AutoApproval_Fields

1. **Trigger:** Record-Triggered Flow on Expense__c, when **updated**
2. **Condition:** Status__c = Approved OR Status__c = Rejected
3. **Action:** Update the record →
 - Approved_By__c = \$User.Id
 - Approval_Date__c = NOW()
4. **Run Flow:** After the record is saved
5. **Save & Activate**

Result: CEO only changes Status, Flow automatically populates approved/rejected user and timestamp.



8. Permission Set for Finance Manager

Step 1: Create Permission Set

1. Setup → Permission Sets → New
2. **Label:** Finance Manager Access
3. **API Name:** Finance_Manager_Access
4. **License:** None → Save

Permission Set [Video Tutorial](#) | [Help for this Page](#)

Facility Manager

Find Settings... | Clone | Manage Assignments | View Summary

Permission Set Overview

Description	Lets users create, read, edit, and delete locations, sublocations, queued parties, and queues.	API Name	SchedulingFacilityManagerPsl
License	Facility Manager	Namespace Prefix	force
Session Activation Required	☐	Created By	salesforce.com, inc., 6/24/2025, 2:27 AM
Permission Set Groups Added To	0	Last Modified By	salesforce.com, inc., 9/30/2025, 9:38 PM

Step 2: Grant Object Permissions

1. Open the Permission Set → Object Settings → Expense
2. Click **Edit**
3. Check: Read ☒, Create ☒, Edit ☒, Delete (optional)

4. Save

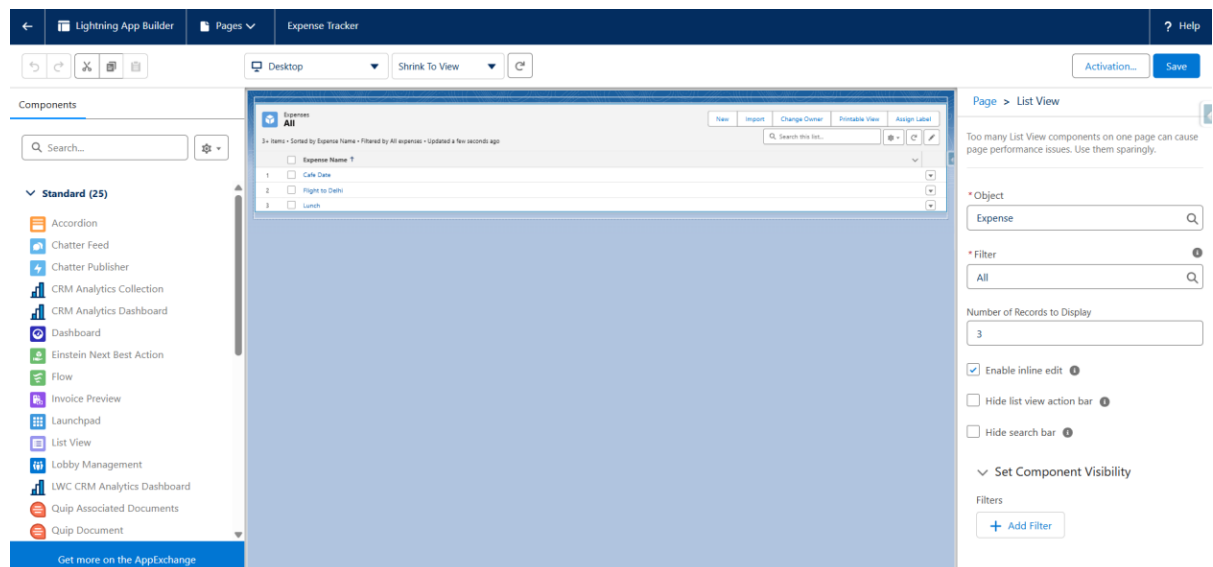
Step 3: Assign Permission Set

1. In Permission Set → Manage Assignments → Add Assignments
2. Select **Finance Manager user** → Assign → Done

Result: Finance Manager can now create Expense records without creating a new profile.

9. User Interface Development – Lightning App Page

1. Setup → App Builder → New → App Page
2. Name: Expense Tracker
3. Layout: One Region → Finish
4. Drag **List View** component → Object: Expense → Default List View
5. Optional: Drag a **Chart** component for “Expenses by Status”
6. Save → Activate → Set as Org Default



10. Data Management – Sample Records

Expense Name Amount Date Category Status

Flight to Delhi	600	Today	Travel	Submitted (Flow updates to Need Approval)
Lunch	150	Today	Food	Submitted (Flow auto-approves)
Office Supplies	300	Today	Office	Submitted (Flow auto-approves)

11 Reports & Dashboards

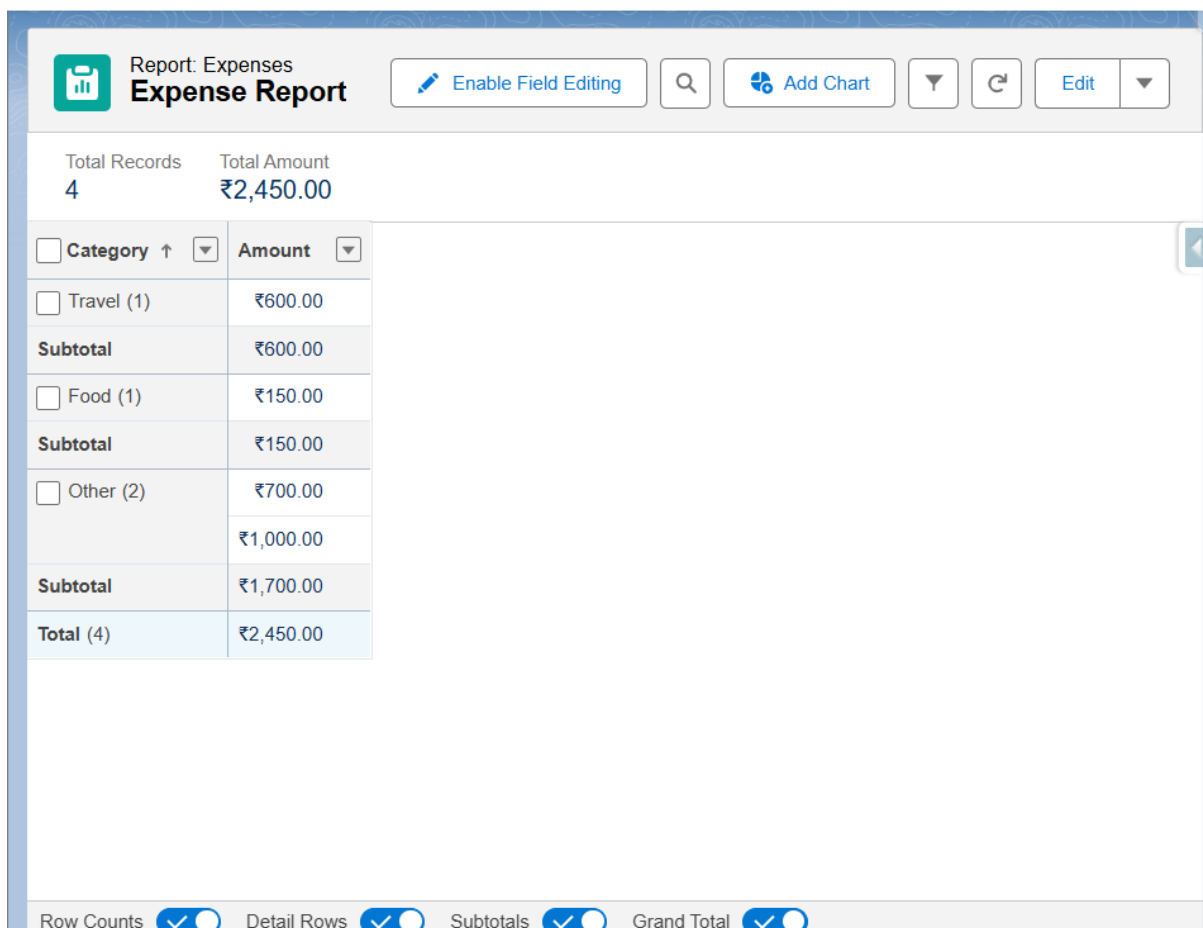
Step 1: Create Report

1. Setup → Reports → New Report → Expense
2. Group by: Category
3. Summarize: Amount (Sum)
4. Save → Expense Report

Step 2: Create Dashboard

1. Setup → Dashboards → New Dashboard
2. Name: Expense Dashboard

Add Component: Chart → Source: Expense Report → Chart Type: Pie → Group by: Category



The screenshot displays the 'Expense Report' interface. At the top, there's a header with a report icon, the title 'Report: Expenses Expense Report', and several action buttons: 'Enable Field Editing', a search icon, 'Add Chart', a filter icon, a refresh icon, and an 'Edit' button with a dropdown arrow. Below the header, summary statistics are shown: 'Total Records: 4' and 'Total Amount: ₹2,450.00'. The main content area features a table with two columns: 'Category' and 'Amount'. The table is grouped by category, showing 'Travel (1)', 'Food (1)', and 'Other (2)' with their respective subtotals. At the bottom, there's a footer with four toggle switches: 'Row Counts', 'Detail Rows', 'Subtotals', and 'Grand Total', all of which are currently turned on.

Category	Amount
Travel (1)	₹600.00
Subtotal	₹600.00
Food (1)	₹150.00
Subtotal	₹150.00
Other (2)	₹700.00
	₹1,000.00
Subtotal	₹1,700.00
Total (4)	₹2,450.00

Row Counts ☒ Detail Rows ☒ Subtotals ☒ Grand Total ☒

12. Testing Steps

1. Create record ≤ 500 : Status = Approved automatically

2. **Create record > 500:** Status = Need Approval
 3. **CEO edits record → Status = Approved/Rejected:**
 - Approved_By__c and Approval_Date__c auto-filled via Flow
 4. **Finance Manager creates record:** Permission Set enables New button
 5. **Check Reports/Dashboard:** Totals updated correctly
 6. **Attempt to edit Approved/Rejected record:** Validation rule prevents changes
-

13. Summary of Features

- **Custom Object:** Expense__c
 - **Fields:** Amount, Date, Category, Status, Approved By, Approval Date, Rejection Reason
 - **Roles & Users:** CEO and Finance Manager
 - **Sharing:** Private + Role Hierarchy
 - **Permission Set:** Grants Finance Manager Create/Edit access
 - **Flows:**
 - Auto-flag high expenses
 - Auto-populate approval/rejection fields
 - **Validation Rule:** Lock approved/rejected records
 - **Lightning App Page:** List View + optional chart
 - **Reports & Dashboards:** Expense summary by category, status, and approver
-

14. Future Enhancements

- Slack/Email notifications on approval/rejection
- Receipt upload field for proof of expense
- Advanced dashboards with monthly filters